

Self-Harm & Suicide Risk Management

SECTIONS 1-4: PURPOSE, SCOPE, RESPONSIBILITIES & RISK ASSESSMENT

1 PURPOSE

To promote the mental health and emotional wellbeing of all children and young people in our care and to effectively identify, assess, and manage risks of self-harm and suicide in accordance with Tusla guidance, HIQA National Standards for Children's Residential Centres, Children First 2017, and best practice mental health protocols.

2 SCOPE

- ✓ All children and young people in Chosanta placements, including those with known mental health needs
- ✓ All staff involved in daily care, key working, observation, and crisis response
- ✓ Risk identification, assessment, safety planning, intervention, and post-incident support
- ✓ Collaboration with families, CAMHS, Tusla, and external services across all settings

3 RESPONSIBILITIES

- ✓ **Provider & PIC:** Ensure resources, specialist access, training, and robust oversight
- ✓ **Care Staff & Key Workers:** Observe changes in presentation, engage sensitively, record, and report concerns
- ✓ **Healthcare Professionals:** Conduct clinical assessments and advise on care/safety plans
- ✓ **Management & Designated Leads:** Oversee plans, multi-agency liaison, and reviews
- ✓ **All Staff:** Maintain supportive, non-judgemental approach and complete required training

4 RISK ASSESSMENT

- ✓ Comprehensive risk assessments completed on admission, after incidents, and regularly reviewed
- ✓ Individual safety plans developed collaboratively with the young person where possible
- ✓ Triggers, warning signs, protective factors, and observation levels clearly documented
- ✓ Use of validated tools with input from mental health professionals
- ✓ Environmental risks (ligature points, means) assessed and mitigated promptly

Self-Harm & Suicide Risk Management

SECTIONS 5-7: YOUNG PERSON INVOLVEMENT, RESPONSE PROTOCOLS & SUPPORT MEASURES

5 YOUNG PERSON INVOLVEMENT

- ✓ Children and young people actively encouraged to contribute to their safety and care plans
- ✓ Views and preferences respected and documented
- ✓ Opportunities to express feelings through key work, creative activities, and feedback mechanisms
- ✓ Access to independent advocacy and support explained
- ✓ Dignity, privacy, and empowerment central to all interactions

6 RESPONSE PROTOCOLS

- ✓ Clear step-by-step escalation pathway for any disclosure or observed risk
- ✓ Immediate safety measures including enhanced supervision and medical attention
- ✓ Post-incident debrief, medical review, and multi-agency notification as required
- ✓ Thorough recording and internal investigation of incidents
- ✓ Staff support and debrief provided after serious events

7 SUPPORT MEASURES

- ✓ Access to CAMHS, counselling, psychology, and therapeutic interventions facilitated
- ✓ Development of positive coping strategies, emotional regulation skills, and resilience building
- ✓ Family involvement encouraged where in the best interests of the child
- ✓ Peer support, meaningful activities, and distraction techniques promoted
- ✓ Ongoing monitoring and adjustment of plans following any incident

Self-Harm & Suicide Risk Management

Page 3

SECTIONS 8-10: TRAINING & COMPLIANCE, MONITORING & POLICY REVIEW

8 TRAINING & COMPLIANCE

- All staff complete accredited mental health awareness, self-harm, and suicide prevention training
- Accurate, timely, and confidential recording in line with GDPR and best practice
- Regular environmental safety audits and risk mitigation actions
- Secure storage of medications and potential means
- Immediate corrective action taken on any identified shortfalls

9 MONITORING & REVIEW

- Regular audits of risk assessments, safety plans, and incident records
- Feedback from young people, families, and staff analysed for improvement
- Multi-disciplinary reviews of serious or repeated incidents
- Trends in self-harm/suicide-related events examined
- Staff supervision and competency in mental health support regularly assessed

10 POLICY REVIEW

- Reviewed annually by management or sooner if required following incidents or guidance changes
- Incorporates audit findings, stakeholder feedback, serious case reviews, and regulatory updates
- Considers trends related to self-harm, suicide risk, and mental health support
- Reviewed policy approved by Registered Provider and communicated to all staff with training and sign-off
- Superseded versions archived per record management procedures